KUBERNETES SECRET vs SVG BUNDLE — BASE64 IS A WRAPPER, NOT A LOCK

both carry encoded bytes inside a text format; only one of them can be locked

Dashed = a gap. Numbers match the security gaps article.

SAME WRAPPER, TWO PATHS

Kubernetes Secret: configuration the cluster decodes

```
apiVersion: v1
kind: Secret
metadata:
  name: db
data:
  password: c3VwZXItc2VjcmV0
  # base64 of "super-secret"
```

Committed to Git (1)
base64 in history forever: anyone with the repo

etcd (24)
stored as base64, unless encryption at rest is on

API server · RBAC
decides who may get or list the Secret

Pod
mounted as a file, decoded: super-secret

SVG bundle: content the browser decodes

```
<svg xmlns="…">
  <metadata>MRN 0042</metadata>
  <image href="data:image/svg+xml;
    base64,PHN2ZyBvbmxvYWQ9ImZldGNoKA==…"/>
</svg>

  # the nested SVG carries onload=…
```

Anyone with the file (1) (7)
decodes every embedded byte, metadata included

or

Browser
decodes every data URI it meets

<img> or <image>
drawn as a picture: no script runs

Inline <svg> (3)
the outer file's script runs on your origin

WHERE THEY ARE ALIKE, AND WHERE THEY DIFFER

CONCERN	KUBERNETES SECRET	SVG BUNDLE
Text format	YAML or JSON	XML
What's encoded	Passwords, keys, certificates under data:	Images, fonts or other SVGs in data: URIs
Who decodes it	The cluster, into a pod's files or environment	The browser, as it draws
Access control	RBAC on get, list and watch	None once shipped: the file is the content
Encryption at rest	Possible: etcd encryption with a KMS provider	Not possible: the bytes are the content
Can it execute	No: it is configuration	Yes, when the outer SVG is inlined (gap 3)
A text scanner sees	Only the encoded value (gap 2)	Only the encoded payload (gap 2)

THE SHARED LESSON

Decode before you scan (2)
Secret scanners must decode data: values;
SVG sanitizers must open nested data URIs.

Keep secrets out of both (1)
A Secret YAML in Git and an SVG with an embedded payload leak the same way.

Only one has a lock (24) (7)
Kubernetes: RBAC plus etcd encryption.
An SVG: carry nothing private at all.

Base64 changes how bytes are written, not who can read them.